Subject: Letter in Support of the Nomination of Amay Kashyap Deka for the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2026

Replace with **To the Selection Committee, Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2026.**

I write in strong support of the nomination of Shri Amay Kashyap Deka, a 17-year-old student of Delhi Public School, Guwahati, for the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar, in recognition of his innovation, "SwiftDx," and his broader record of achievement in science and technology.

I met Amay at an event at his school, where I was invited as the chief guest. This is when he presented SwiftDx and its proposed application in resource-constrained surgical settings. It was refreshing to see his role in the ideation along with the software integration for the product. I subsequently reviewed the prototype demonstration, technical briefs and was significantly impressed by the niche this idea captures.

Access to on-site frozen section pathology is limited in many of our district and sub-divisional hospitals, and patients in such settings often face delays and long journeys to nearby district hopitals. SwiftDx is a diagnostic innovation that uses autofluorescence lasers, machine learning, and vision-language models to assess tumour margins during surgery itself. By moving this assessment out of a specialised pathology lab and into the operating theatre, and by allowing it to be carried out by a lab technician rather than a specialised pathologist, SwiftDx addresses a problem I consider especially significant in districts such as Kokrajhar and across other lower-resourced areas of Assam and the wider Northeast.

An innovation that brings this capability closer to the patient has the potential to meaningfully improve surgical cancer care in exactly the kind of underserved settings this district represents. I view this as work of genuine public value, and precisely the sort of youth innovation the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar is intended to recognise and encourage.

It is also worth noting that SwiftDx has already earned recognition well beyond the district and the state, having been selected among twenty global winners of the Harvard Systems and Innovations Lab Hackathon, and having gone on to secure collaborations with the 6 partner hospitals and expressions of interest from the Commonwealth Medical Association and the National Cancer Society for further validation and scale.

In my capacity as Chancellor of Kokrajhar Medical College, I am also personally keen to see SwiftDx clinically validated through the College. I believe this district is well placed to reap the benefits if a pilot were successful, and I would welcome the opportunity to facilitate this in whatever way is appropriate.

Beyond this innovation, Amay has separately distinguished himself at the national level in the fields of science and mathematics. He has performed strongly in the Indian National Mathematics Olympiad and the Indian National Chemistry Olympiad, and has undertaken

research through the Adani Group-sponsored Research Science Initiative India (RSI-India), at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru. Taken together, this record reflects a sustained and serious commitment to science and technology that, in my assessment, is rare for a student of his age.

I recommend Amay Kashyap Deka's nomination to the Science and Technology category of the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar committee without reservation, and would be glad to provide any further information the selection committee may require.

Yours sincerely,